

Section 17

Public Interest & Community Engagement

Version 2.0 — Preliminary Draft

Petitioner: Ashley Marie Meredith, MSN | Pro Se

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PETITION TO AUDIT — IOWA DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

SECTION 17 — PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT & INDEPENDENT CORROBORATION

External Witness Record

Version 1.0 — June 5, 2026

Audit Petition Packet v2.0 (5/2026)

17.0 PURPOSE AND EVIDENTIARY FUNCTION

Sections 14 through 16 of this petition establish the case-level outcome record: the Drew criminal convictions (A33), the financial liability and pattern corroboration from independent media sources (A35–A38), and the petitioner's documented exhaustion of reporting channels over a seven-year period (A39, A40).

Section 17 introduces a third-party witness record that stands

entirely independent of the petitioner's account. The material in this section was generated by an individual with no connection to this petition, no prior relationship with the petitioner, and no awareness that this petition was being prepared at the time her reports were filed. Her concerns were raised through official channels — directly to the Washington County Attorney's office — beginning November 6, 2025, and continued through April 8, 2026.

The evidentiary significance of this record is structural: it documents that a second independent adult, observing the Drew household from an entirely different vantage point and through entirely different channels, reached substantially similar

conclusions about the ongoing risk presented by the Drew household — and received substantially similar institutional non-response.

This section presents that record in its documentary form. The underlying correspondence and supporting materials are included as Attachment A41. No affidavit has been submitted in connection with this section at the time of this petition's filing. The documentary record stands independently on the strength of the authenticated email correspondence it contains.

17.1 THE BUCKINGHAM/TWEEDY CORRESPONDENCE RECORD

17.1.1 Identity and Basis of Knowledge

The individual who generated this correspondence record is Amanda Lea Tweedy (formerly Amanda Lea Buckingham), a resident of McLeod County, Minnesota. Her basis for knowledge of the Drew household is entirely independent of this petitioner: beginning in approximately October 2025, Ashley Marie Drew entered into a relationship with Tweedy's then-estranged husband, Jeffrey Buckingham, Sr., and was regularly present in the home shared by Mr. Buckingham and their three minor children (ages 6, 8, and 14 as of October 2025) during his parenting time.

Tweedy had no prior knowledge of the Drew criminal convictions, no connection to the Iowa child welfare system, and no awareness of this petition at the time she began her reporting. She identified Ashley Drew's criminal history independently through her own investigation after observing concerning conduct.

17.1.2 Document Contents — Attachment A41

The Buckingham/Tweedy correspondence file (Attachment A41) contains the following authenticated materials:

(a) Email from Amanda Buckingham to Washington County Attorney Nathan Repp, November 6, 2025 — initial report raising concerns regarding Ashley Drew's probation status, conduct around minor children, and observable household conditions. Marked "Importance: High" in the original email header.

(b) Reply from Nathan Repp, November 26, 2025 — acknowledging receipt, stating "I can assure you that the situation is being looked into," and offering to schedule a follow-up meeting.

(c) Email from Amanda Buckingham to Nathan Repp, November 29, 2025 — follow-up providing additional detail, referencing the McLeod County divorce trial at which Tweedy had testified about Ashley Drew's presence in the home and the sleeping arrangements.

(d) Email from Amanda Buckingham to Nathan Repp, December 8, 2025 — second follow-up enclosing photographic attachments (four images) documenting Ashley Drew's enrollment of her children in Minnesota school athletic programs while residing at the Buckingham address, raising the question of whether this constituted a probation violation.

(e) Email from Amanda Buckingham to Nathan Repp, February 19, 2026 — third follow-up documenting continued residence pattern, additional boundary concerns involving minor children, and Ashley Drew's use of Tweedy's divorce documents with Tweedy's minor daughter.

(f) Email from Amanda Tweedy to Nathan Repp, April 8, 2026 — final correspondence in the record, providing two additional documented facts: (1) finalization of Tweedy's divorce decree in McLeod County, Minnesota on April 6, 2026 (Court File No. 43-FA-24-905), which explicitly prohibits Jeffrey Buckingham from leaving the minor children in the care or supervision of Ashley Drew; and (2) continued use of the false surname "Buckingham" by Ashley Drew on school paperwork.

(g) Forwarding chain — email from Ann Caslavka, Office Manager, Washington County Attorney's Office, to Nathan Repp, November 6, 2025, subject: "FW: Ashley Marie Drew" marked "Importance: High" — confirming internal routing of Tweedy's initial report within the Washington County

Attorney's office.

(h) Detailed chronological narrative authored by Tweedy, documenting observed incidents from October 5, 2025 through February 2026, including dated entries with specific observations regarding the Drew children.

(i) Tweedy's documented contacts with multiple agencies in addition to the Washington County Attorney: McLeod County Sheriff's Office (Minnesota), Minnesota State Parole Board, Minnesota CPS, and Ashley Drew's Iowa probation officer (Colby, Washington County, Iowa; telephone 319-598-1351). Tweedy documents that each agency told her there was "nothing they could do."

17.1.3 The Minnesota Divorce Decree — Court File 43-FA-24-905

The April 8, 2026 correspondence references the finalization of Tweedy's divorce decree in McLeod County, Minnesota District Court (Court File No. 43-FA-24-905), entered April 6, 2026.

Per Tweedy's correspondence, the decree explicitly prohibits Jeffrey Buckingham from leaving the minor children in the care or supervision of Ashley Drew. The decree is referenced in the April 8, 2026 email as a court-ordered finding based on information brought to the judge during the divorce trial.

The audit-relevant significance of this decree is narrow and specific: a Minnesota district court judge, acting on testimony presented in a civil divorce proceeding, made an independent judicial finding sufficient to support a protective restriction regarding Ashley Drew's contact with minor children — at a point in time when Ashley Drew was on probation in Iowa for felony child endangerment resulting in bodily injury. That finding was made by a court with no connection to Iowa DHHS, no connection to this petitioner, and no connection to the Iowa child welfare system. It constitutes an independent judicial determination of ongoing risk.

The question this fact generates for audit purposes: was Iowa DHHS's probation monitoring infrastructure — or any Iowa

oversight authority — aware of the McLeod County protective restriction entered April 6, 2026, and if so, what action, if any, was taken?

17.2 INSTITUTIONAL RESPONSE PATTERN

17.2.1 Washington County Attorney — Response Record

Nathan Repp, Washington County Attorney, received five separate written communications from Tweedy between November 6, 2025 and April 8, 2026. The documented response record is as follows:

November 6, 2025: Initial report received and internally forwarded (confirmed by Caslavka forwarding email). No documented protective action.

November 26, 2025: Repp replies acknowledging report and stating "the situation is being looked into."
No specific action documented.

November 29, 2025: Tweedy follow-up received. No documented response in the record produced.

December 8, 2025: Tweedy second follow-up with photographic evidence received. No documented response in the record produced.

February 19, 2026: Tweedy third follow-up received. No documented response in the record produced.

April 8, 2026: Tweedy fourth follow-up referencing the Minnesota divorce decree and false name use on school paperwork. No documented response in the record produced.

Summary: Five written reports submitted to the Washington County Attorney over five months. One written acknowledgment produced. No documented protective action, referral, probation enforcement contact, or follow-up response to any of the four subsequent communications.

17.2.2 Multi-Agency Non-Response

Tweedy's own documented account records contact with five separate agencies or officials regarding her concerns:

1. McLeod County Sheriff's Office (Minnesota)
2. Minnesota State Parole Board
3. Minnesota CPS
4. Iowa probation officer Colby (Washington County, Iowa; 319-598-1351) — contacted October 2025
5. Washington County Attorney Nathan Repp (Iowa) — five written contacts November 2025 through April 2026

Per Tweedy's documented account, each agency she contacted communicated that there was nothing they could do. The Iowa probation officer advised that a two-week travel allowance was in place and that compliance meant returning to Wisconsin periodically — despite Tweedy's direct report that Drew was residing in Minnesota full-time and using the Wisconsin address only to satisfy the travel policy.

17.2.3 Structural Observation

The institutional response pattern documented in this section — multiple formal reports to multiple agencies across multiple jurisdictions, producing no documented coordinated protective action — is directly consistent with Deficiency Category F11 (Interagency Coordination Failure) and F12 (Supervisory Review & Escalation Failure) as documented across the longitudinal CFSR record in Sections 6 through 13 of this petition.

This is not the petitioner's account. This is a separate individual's documented experience of the same reporting architecture, generating the same institutional non-response pattern, in the same geographic jurisdiction, during the same period under audit review.

17.3 SCOPE LIMITATIONS AND CHARACTERIZATION BOUNDARIES

The following scope limitations govern this section's use of the Buckingham/Tweedy record:

LIMITATION 1 — CLAIMS RELIED UPON:

This section relies on the following categories of claim from the Buckingham/Tweedy correspondence:

- (a) The fact and content of authenticated email correspondence with Nathan Repp's office — Reliability A.
- (b) The fact and content of the McLeod County divorce decree (Court File 43-FA-24-905) as referenced in the April 8, 2026 correspondence — Reliability A.
- (c) Tweedy's documented account of her agency contacts and the responses she received — Reliability B (first-person account, not independently verified).

This section does NOT rely on Tweedy's specific observational claims regarding conditions in the Drew household for factual assertions in the petition. Those claims are noted in the document description for completeness. They are not the basis for any finding in this section.

LIMITATION 2 — NO AFFIDAVIT AT TIME OF FILING:

No sworn affidavit from Amanda Tweedy has been submitted with this petition at the time of filing. The correspondence record stands independently. If a sworn affidavit is subsequently executed and submitted, it will be filed as a supplemental exhibit to this petition.

LIMITATION 3 — SCOPE OF AUDIT QUESTIONS:

The audit questions generated by this section are directed exclusively at Iowa DHHS monitoring and probation oversight functions. They do not ask the auditor to adjudicate the domestic proceedings in McLeod County, Minnesota, or to make findings regarding Jeffrey Buckingham or any non-agency party.

17.4 AUDIT QUESTIONS GENERATED

AUDIT QUESTION 17-A: Did Iowa DHHS or its probation monitoring authority receive any report, referral, or notification from any of the five agencies contacted by Tweedy — including the Iowa

probation officer documented in the correspondence — between October 2025 and April 2026, and if so, what action was taken?

AUDIT QUESTION 17-B: What protocols govern the Iowa probation monitoring authority's response when an external party reports that a probationer is residing outside the state of supervision while using periodic returns to satisfy a travel policy? Were those protocols followed in the period October 2025 through April 2026?

AUDIT QUESTION 17-C: Was the McLeod County District Court's April 6, 2026 protective restriction (Court File 43-FA-24-905) communicated to Iowa DHHS, the Washington County Attorney's office, or the Iowa probation authority? If so, what action was taken?

17.5 DOMAIN & DEFICIENCY MAPPING — SECTION 17

Domain B — Contract & Provider Oversight:

Post-conviction monitoring of a former licensed foster provider is a Domain B function. The documentation in this section raises questions about whether that monitoring function was operational during the period under review.

F2 — Ongoing Monitoring Deficiency: Multi-agency report pattern producing no documented coordinated response is consistent with an ongoing monitoring gap at the post-conviction supervision level.

Domain D — Judicial Interface & Structural Influence:

The McLeod County divorce decree's protective restriction constitutes an independent judicial finding relevant to the ongoing risk assessment for a former Iowa licensee on active probation supervision.

F11 — Interagency Coordination Failure: Absence of documented coordination between the Minnesota court finding and Iowa supervision authority is consistent with the interagency coordination deficiencies documented throughout this petition.

Domain F — Internal Accountability & Workforce Erosion:

Washington County Attorney's single-acknowledgment response to five formal written reports over five months, with no documented follow-up action on four subsequent communications, is a supervisory escalation failure.

F12 — Supervisory Review & Escalation Failure: The Caslavka forwarding email confirms internal routing occurred. Absence of documented protective action following internal routing is consistent with an escalation failure at the supervisory review level.

Domain G — Federal Reviews & Repeat Findings:

The multi-agency non-response pattern documented here corroborates the systemic reporting channel failures identified in CFSR Rounds 1–4 and Ombudsman annual reporting. A separate individual, in a separate year, through separate channels, encountered the same institutional architecture and the same result.

F5 — Corrective Action Failure: The absence of any documented systemic correction to the reporting and escalation architecture between the Duis/Finn/Ray period and the 2025–2026 Tweedy correspondence period is itself an F5 finding.

SECTION 17 — CROSS-REFERENCES

Section 14: Drew criminal dockets (A33) — primary conviction
record establishing the probation context within
which this correspondence was generated

Section 15: Public impact and pattern corroboration (A37, A38)
— Mitchell multi-county parallel to the reporting
channel non-response documented here

Section 16: Petitioner affidavits (A39, A40) — petitioner's
own reporting channel record; parallel non-response
pattern from independent source

Section 12: Ombudsman reporting channel analysis — structural

context for systemic reporting channel failure

Section 19: Corrective Action Matrix — post-conviction

monitoring protocol remediation scope

A41: Buckingham/Tweedy correspondence file — all
authenticated correspondence cited in this section
CFSR Companion Report, Section 4: Extended analysis of
reporting channel structural failure pattern

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

End of Section 17 — Version 1.0 — June 5, 2026
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AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

AI assistance was used materially in the preparation of this document. That assistance does not constitute independent verification of any factual claim.